

This week is פרשת דברים which is שבת חזון. Before we start, I want to just wish Dovid Bennett a מזל טוב on his birthday, and I hope you lein well.

In the הפטרה of חזון is the pasuk: וְשָׁבָהּ בְּצִדְקָה - Tziyon, which R' Chaim Kanievisky explains refers to the בית המקדש, will be returned to us through משפט, through justice. The בית המקדש did not do any עבירה. Therefore, it is only just that it should be restored as soon as possible. However, תשובה - the people of ירושלים, those who are returning to her, who are human beings - have to do צדקה. That part can only happen through צדקה, with righteousness. If we do תשובה הוא, תשובה הוא, תשובה הוא will return the people and the בית המקדש.

R' Chaim addresses a fascinating problem. My brother, עליו השלום, always made a point of saying the ברכה in bentching אמן בונה ירושלים. He emphasized that it says בונה ירושלים, implying it will be rebuilt without רחמים. But we usually say: בונה ברחמי ירושלים אמן. So which is it?

In fact, it's brought down that no less than the גאון himself would leave out the word ברחמי and just say בונה ירושלים. So how can one say that ירושלים will be rebuilt without רחמים? That's really a שאלה on the גר"א.

Rav Chaim brings many ראיות that we should say ברחמי. One of them is a pasuk in זכריה א' ט"ז: וְהָיָה בְּיוֹם הַהוּא יֹאמַר ה' אֱלֹהֵינוּ בְּשׁוֹבְךָ לְצִיּוֹן בְּרַחֲמִים: שמונה עשרה. Another is what we say three times a day in שמונה עשרה: בְּרַחֲמִים. לירושלם ברחמים. We also say ברחמים there. And again in שמונה עשרה we say: בְּרַחֲמִים תָּשׁוּב: So we know that Hashem will grant us רחמים in the rebuilding of ירושלים.

So he says, based on the pasuk we just quoted, that yes, Hashem will return through רחמים. However, בונה, בונה, to rebuild ירושלים - and that refers specifically to the בית המקדש - that will be done with משפט, because that is what is just and right, that the בית המקדש should be rebuilt with משפט.

Therefore, it behooves us to focus on both of these aspects. We have to be ישרותדיק in our entire lives, in our dealings certainly לבין אדם, and even לבין אדם. But we also have to increase our צדקה. We have to do more in terms of תשובה, תפלה, and צדקה. We're heading into אלול, into the new year. We know that these are the three critical elements that we need in order to ensure that we'll have, אם ירצה השם, א גוט. And we will, אם ירצה השם, come together for שמחות - with צדקה, with משפט, and with נחת.

